Volume 2 Issue 4 Spring 2009

Hollerbeier Haven

Newsletter for the Herbal and Healing Arts



CONTENTS

The Coming of Elijah Finn	2
At the Time of Birthing	3
Der Urglaawe	4
Seasonal Celebrations	6
Ansur– The Mouth	7
Still Living the Good Life	8
Four Humors Medicine—Part 2	10
Yarrow~ A Thousand Leaves	11
Our Authentic Heirlooms	14
Living Land	16
Die Versommling	17
Blatant Advertising	18 -19

With every season comes changes. At the Three Sisters Center we have undergone quite a few in the past few months.

Jesse has continued to teach classes and guild meetings, but the location has changed (hopefully for the last time!). She now teaches Der Braucherei Weg and the Hollerbeier Haven Guild Gatherings from her office near Kutztown. The first few classes were a juggle with the new baby, but Elijah is old enough for the baby sitter now (his Grammy), and the classes are flowing much more smoothly.

For the past year Der Braucherei Weg has been available as a distance course. This year we are making the Guild Gatherings available to distance students as well: we are recording each event, making the recordings available as a CD. So far we only have March's meeting recorded, but we intend for all guild meetings to be available in the coming months and years!

Matthew has begun the process of building a home for himself, Jesse, and Elijah. He is doing much of the building himself, and using traditional methods and design components when possible. This process began with the felling of a great oak for the summerbeam, which he is now in the process of hand hewing with his cousin, Steve. He will be documenting his process throughout the year and sharing it with all of you in photo and written documentation. The year will be full of excitement and trials, no doubt, but hopefully we will have a home to come home to come Christmas time!

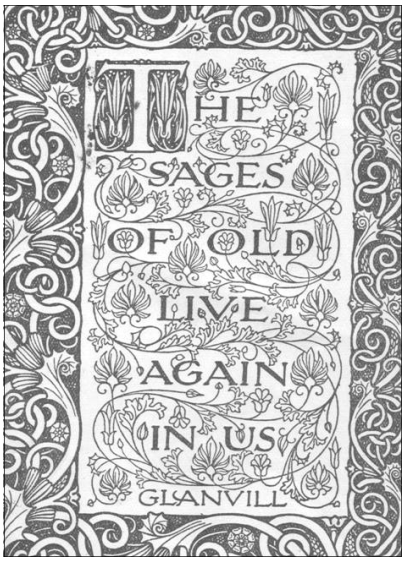
Annie has taken on some new challenges this year and is spending her summer in northern PA, learning how to farm with a team of oxen! She is undergoing an experience that few Americans of her generation have ever known. She will also be sharing with us her experiences in this new adventure.

Susan's business at the Farm at Coventry has been flourishing this year, quite a blessing when so many people have found themselves out of work! Sadly, she has decided that her commitments to her business ventures have become too much to continue to act as editor for Hollerbeier Haven. Jesse will be taking over as editor in the coming year, and everyone from the Kutzeschteddel Raad will be contributing articles.



Here's hoping you all have a fine spring to come!

Blessings, Jesse and Susan



The Three Sisters Center for the Healing Arts is recording stories, interviews, memories, and knowledge of the healing traditions of Pow-wow or Braucherei. We are creating an archive of this tradition in order to preserve our heritage and ensure the practice. If you know anyone who practices or has a story to tell, we'd love to hear from you; whether you'd like to give a personal interview or prefer to remain anonymous, simply write to us. Your personal experiences are culturally valuable and will be treated with the utmost respect. You can contact us with questions or information by writing to:

The Three Sisters Center for the Healing Arts
(Transcription)
P.O. Box 88
Kempton, PA 19529

Three Sisters Center
for the Healing Arts
PO Box 88
Kempton, PA
19529

Visit us on the Web :
www.ThreeSistersCenter.com
email us: Thr3Sisters@aol.com
Call Jesse Tobin 484-336-4611
Call Susan Hess 610-469-9591

The Coming of Elijah Finn~ Jesse Tobin

When I realized I was pregnant a year ago I was filled with joy, hope, and love for my growing child. I knew that this experience of bringing new life to the world would change my life and myself forever. I knew I would love this child more than I could yet conceive. I knew all of these things in a very logical and cerebral sense but knowing is nothing compared with experiencing.

At Lichtmess last year, we prayed to the Holy Mother to bring us a child. We asked her to bless that child with health, beauty, strength, and wisdom. We asked her to deliver both baby and mother safely into their new lives. I prayed for the strength to endure the physical trials that stood before me as well as the emotional ones. We chose to make this prayer at Lichtmess because it is the time of the Holy Mother, time to honor her and the divine presence in all women. Hers is the realm of conception and birth, of nurturance and the rearing of young ones.

After 10 years in a devoted relationship with my husband, with no children yet, I feared that we would have challenges in conception. She answered our call, though, and swiftly. By the end of February last year, our child was growing. I was full of conflicting emotions: I was overjoyed to be so blessed, but I also wondered: was I ready? Was I worthy? Would I ever have time to do anything else ever again? I worried that something might go wrong, or that something I did would hurt the baby.

Pregnancy had its challenges, and though I complained at the time, none were too great to manage. When the day came for birth, labor came on slowly enough for me to prepare myself. I asked the Holy Mother to give me strength, to enter my body and fill me with confidence. Our labor was not long, just shy of ten hours. There were no complications, so it was a simple labor in that way. That being said, no labor should be termed simple, easy, or light.

The power and strength of the birthing muscles overcome all else in the time of labor. I found myself in a perfect state of present moment awareness. I had no identity, I had no opinions (maybe for the first time in my life), I had no awareness outside of each passing moment. People have asked me since Elijah's birth how I could give birth with no drugs. In truth, during my labor my attention was so focused in the present that I forgot that drugs were an option, I never even thought of them. I only rode each wave of muscles contracting and relaxing. I gave my body over to her who knows this process best, and trusted in her wisdom to deliver us both in safety and health.

At the moment of birth, my relief and disbelief was so great that I could not understand for a few moments that the labor was over, the baby was here, and all was well. It must have been a full minute before I remembered to look to see what gender my baby was. A boy... Elijah Finn Sicher.

Then every other relief: all his parts were perfect miniatures of his father, his startled blue eyes looked around with astounding alertness, his breaths were strong and steady, as were his heartbeats... perfect, a perfect baby.

I was in love immediately, but every day that love grew in its strength and in its depth, and I think this is how it will grow until the day I die. As I write this I am aware that my love is ever-deepening. I think it is impossible for any love to be greater than that of a mother for her child. This joy is so big that it holds sadness within it; it is complete. I have heard it said that a newborn baby steals the heart of its mother, and she belongs to him for the rest of her life. It is true.

At the Time of Birthing ~ Jesse Tobin



Amongst the wisdom passed on through the Oley Freindschaft was quite a bit of information about ceremony, belief, and tradition surrounding conception, pregnancy, birth, and the bringing forth of a child into the wider world. This information seems relevant at this time when we are celebrating the renewal of life in the natural world. In modern society magical protection is rarely considered. Most people walk around through their daily lives without any consideration of this sort of protection whatsoever. In all traditional societies protection is of the utmost importance, and few endeavors are begun without at least a prayer or words of blessing.

The protection of children is of particular importance in Braucherei tradition as in most traditional societies. Children are as yet unable to protect themselves physically, mentally, emotionally, and psychically as well. It is because of the extreme absence of this sort of knowledge in modern culture that I feel compelled to share the traditions that have been passed to us at Three Sisters'.

The process of parenting begins well before the time of conception. When it is possible, both mother and father should prepare themselves physically and emotionally for parenthood well before their child is on its way. Preparations for pregnancy often include fasting, cleanses, and building up the physical body to a high state of health. There are particular foods that are recommended in Deitsch tradition. Among these are eggs, especially the eggs of fish. Rich foods like shellfish and organ meats were also recommended in times past. All of these foods are exceptionally rich sources of vitamins and minerals. In modern times, however, we must also consider the levels of heavy metals and pesticides that may also become extra concentrated in these foods. In light of this it is important to be informed about the conditions in which such animals were raised, in order to know how clean the meat will be.

Before conception of a child, the mother and father may wish to hold a ceremony together, (which can be as simple or complex as both of them wish) in order to invite spirit to dwell in flesh in the form of their child. Often conception is easy for couples, or even accidental. What a wonderful blessing it is for a couple to find conception so easy! Sadly there are many who find themselves childless despite their attempts at conception. What a sad thing it is that so many children are born unwanted to resentful or even harmful parents, when so many potentially loving parents find themselves without children. Brauchers do have certain prayers, energy work, and verses of the Bible that can be used in the case of a difficult conception, but I think perhaps the best thing is for those with infertility problems to consider adoption.

During pregnancy, food recommendations are the same as above. In modern times many of these foods such as shell fish, eggs, and fish eggs could be replaced with things like fish oils or Omega 3 fatty acids. In addition, however, nutrient dense herbs like alfalfa, raspberry leaf, nettles, and seaweeds are recommended. Seaweeds are especially important here, as they also give iodine, which can help to prevent pregnancy-induced hypothyroidism. According to tradition many women would carry amulets with prayers of protection and blessing, herbs, gemstones, etc.

Iron is especially useful as an amulet of protection as it attracts all of the negative energy to itself, sparing the person who wears it. Of course prayers for protection and blessing may also be said on waking and before bed as yet another way to protect the mother and unborn child.

There are many ceremonies that can be employed during the birthing process. Children are seen as especially vulnerable to hexes, particularly the accidental kind. It is believed that negative emotion surrounding a new baby can cause a hex to be cast without a directly harmful intention. Jealousy or resentment on the part of one who cannot have a child, or whose child is ill are just examples of this type of thing. It was against this type of inadvertent hexing that most ceremonies surrounding birth were aimed. I would like to note here that such ceremonies were employed not to harm the one who caused the hex, but simply to shield the child from it.

Continued on page 5...

En Gegegratzichi Schmier vum Hinkeldarm
A Chickweed Anti-Itch Salve
By Rob Lusch

It is spring and nature is already bustling with growth! Do you have chickweed growing all over your backyard? A few years ago, I dismissed this common plant as a weed and a nuisance. After learning some things about this amazing little plant, though, I let it grow in my yard and reap it carefully, being sure to offer thanks for its sacrifice when I am done.

For one thing, this little plant is quite tasty and can add a new flavor to a salad.

But the big wonder for me with this little plant is its amazing ability to combat annoying itches from dry skin, bug bites, etc. It is pretty simple to whip up a batch of this anti-itch salve.

Take one cup of olive oil (cold pressed, extra virgin works best). Bring it to a low heat on the stove in a small- or medium-sized pot or a double-boiler. Do not let it boil.

Once it is warmed up, add as much chickweed as you can. Press it down under the surface until you cannot fit anymore in. Let it sit for about an hour or so, stirring occasionally. Again, do not let it come to a boil.

After it has set for about an hour, add in some melted beeswax, and, if so inclined, an anti-oxidant (Vitamin E or grapefruit seed extract, for example). The amount of beeswax can vary, but it's better to start out with too little than too much. I probably use less than 3 cubic inches.



Continued on page 15

At the time of Birthing continued from page 3...

The most important ceremony from a Braucherei perspective, is what is done with the placenta after the birth. The placenta is so strongly linked to the child that its treatment after birth can be seen to give the child lifelong protection or lifelong harm. In times passed, most Deitsch people would not allow a midwife to take the afterbirth away with her. Instead they would keep it themselves, and treat it in a variety of ways to ensure its safety. According to our training, after the birth of a child the placenta is to be buried beneath a new Elder tree. This Elder should be planted someplace on the family's homestead, and in a place that is sure to remain with the family. For those who were especially cautious in the prevention of hexes, not only the placenta of a child, but all of that child's hair and nail clippings would be buried here to give the child protection. To prevent danger to the child during its most vulnerable time, the newborn baby would also be kept at home at least for the first week, with few if any visitors. Sometimes this homebound period would last for up to a month.

In the Oley Freindschaft, names were considered to be very important. Naturally the name of a child is important, but in our Freindschaft there are many more names for a child than the given name known to all. Early in the child's life, between birth and the three month mark, the child would be taken out into the forest by the parents. This was to be done early in the day, just around daybreak. The parents would walk until an animal or plant presented itself to them. The name of this animal or plant would be taken as the child's secret name, known only to the parents (until the child came of age, at which time the child was given this knowledge as well). This name is referred to as the child's Erdnaame.

The second type of name was just the opposite. In order to Brauch for someone, or conversely, in order to Hex a person, it is believed that the Braucher or Hexerei would have to know the person's full name at birth. In order to protect this given name from those with ill intentions, parents would give their children nicknames called Kinnernaame. These names would be used in public so that most people in the community would not know the true name of a child.

Finally, those who were meant to be Brauchers would be given yet another name that was known only within their Raad (circle) of practitioners. This name served as a final layer of protection.

Traditions of protection have been used against negative magic for millennia much in the way that we now use vaccines: as an inoculation against danger and vulnerability. It seems especially important in modern times to employ such ceremonies and long held tradition. Modern children are exposed to a wide variety of potentially dangerous influences to which our bodies have never before been exposed. Who knows what potential danger the new technologies and chemicals in our air, land and water may hold?

Children also come into contact with a far greater number of people throughout the course of their lives than most children in times past. We swim in a sea of psychic energy, and just as the ocean, much of this psychic sea is polluted with negative energies, emotions, and intentions. As parents of any age we are moved by great devotion and boundless love to do everything in our power to keep our children safe and healthy. These prayerful acts may be seen as attempts to protect our children with much the same intention as we act to provide a safe home and neighborhood. We cannot indeed survive by bread alone. Our children cannot know a truly healthy life merely with physical health, but also require an intact and protected spirit.

Take this wisdom and use it with love for yourselves, your children, and your communities. Give them the protection they need to grow into the



From "*The Thomas R. Brendle Collection of Pennsylvania German Folklore, Volume I*"

Edited by C. Richard Beam

Wann die Hund odder Katze Grass fresse, Gebt's Regge.

Translation to be found somewhere within the pages of this newsletter!!

Grundsaudaag 2009, An Urglaawe Perspective
By Rob Lusch

As Yuul drew to a close and 2008 along with it, the Distelfink Sippschaft's Yuul wreath was set ablaze, carrying our resolutions for 2009 as oaths to ourselves and to the gods and goddesses.

Now it is time to live out the oath, and I will share the content of my resolution right here.

My goal for 2009 is to do my best to help Urglaawe to grow and to flourish. 2008 was a great year of expansion as the first kindred was formed and more Pennsylvania Germans began finding their way back to the gods and goddesses as well as to the old folkways.

The Yuul ceremonies and events brought us back to eating goose (sacred to Holle) as well as pork and sauerkraut (a tradition that never died among the Deitsch Volk). As the majority of American secular Christmas traditions came through the Pennsylvania Germans, the Heathen roots are clear: the tree, Santa and Mrs. Claus, Knecht Rubrecht and other entities in the sleigh, etc., are all based in pre-Christian Teutonic culture.

Now we turn our eyes towards the next holiday. For us,this would be Groundhog Day. This observance has been the source of many jokes and even a Bill Murray movie. However, the Heathen undertones to this day are strong. The Groundhog represents the return of the otherworld travelers. The Wild Hunt is on the wane as the wights return to the land to prepare for the seasons of fertility.

As wights and spirits begin to return from the Wild Hunt, this is a good time for us to work with ancestors (or descendants!) who may need our assistance. Also, this is a strong time for divination and prognostication (hence the groundhog/shadow thing).

This is a time of cleaning, cleansing and preparation. We are to clean our homes (hence spring cleaning) and to cleanse our homes. This would also be the time to allow the fire in the hearth to die out. Then the hearth would be cleaned out, and a new fire begun with birch wood.

The presence of birch and the focus on the hearth and home helps us see the connection of this day to Frigg. Frigg is often misunderstood simply as a goddess of household chores. However, the fact is that she creates the fabric of Wurt and is above the Norns (hence, in essence, is outside of time and Wurt). The significance of such a powerful goddess focusing on the hearth and home serves as an indicator of the importance of the home and family to the gods and goddesses and to our ancestors.

So at our Groundhog Day Sege we will hail Frigg.

While the equinoxes and solstices are solar observances, the cross quarter observances are agricultural or pastoral in nature. The Asatruar charm the plow at this time. In our own culture, Braucherei holds the ceremony of the corn, and we Urglaawer observe this tradition as well.

The focus on agriculture also encourages us to hail Dunner on 2. Hanning. So the next time someone jokes about this being a silly observance, you will know that this is a day steeped in rich history over the course of centuries. It was important enough for the conquering Church to attempt to supplant the local traditions with a holiday, and it was important enough for our ancestors to carry the traditions forward into the modern era.

Hail Frigg! Hail Dunner! Hail the Groundhog! :)

Oschdre **By Rob Lusch**

Oschdre is the Pennsylvania German word for Easter, but its origins are in the name of a Germanic spring goddess. In fact, the word Easter has its roots in the Anglo-Saxon name of the same goddess.

According to Jacob Grimm (Teutonic Mythology, volume I, p. 291), the Old High German adverb of ôstar expresses movement towards the rising sun. Grimm postulates that worship of the goddess must have been so firmly ensconced that the Christians tolerated the use of Her name, even applying it to their highest holiday.

To Urglaawer, Oschdre is indeed one of the highest holidays. It is the vernal equinox, the representation of light over dark, warm over cold, spring over winter, etc. The goddess Oschdre is associated with fertility, hence the appearance of eggs and hares in the secular American celebration of Easter. In fact, much like Yuletide, most of the Eastertide secular observances have their roots in Germanic traditions that were passed through to the wider American culture via the Pennsylvania Germans. Folks who are interested in learning more may want to read *Eastertide in Pennsylvania: A Folk-Cultural Study*, by Alfred L. Shoemaker, though there are plenty of other resources that will be even more candid about the Heathen roots of many traditions that most people consider Christian today.

Distelfink Sippschaft's Oschdre Sege (ceremony) fell on Friday, March 20, this year, as that was the date of the vernal equinox.

Ansur~ The Mouth by Patrick Donmoyer

"Mouth is the origin of speech,
The support of wisdom,
And for everyone a blessing"

~Anglo-Saxon Rune Poem
Thomas Howard Translation

The literal Anglo-Saxon understanding of this rune is the symbolism of the mouth, and the spoken word. However, it seems that this interpretation is unlike the derivation from the word for the Æsir, the Norse gods. These ideas can be complementary, and need not conflict, as the sacred songs, stories and poems passed from one generation to the next revealed the nature and wisdom of the Æsir. Ansur is the open vowel "*a*," which can be likened on several levels to the Hebrew letter *Aleph* and its esoteric relation to breath. In both the Germanic and the Hebrew traditions there is a powerful correspondence between the breath of life, the spoken word and oral sacred tradition. Both cultures also have highly developed esoteric wisdom traditions which are believed to be passed from the divine to human beings. Prior to the written word, both of these early cultures relied entirely upon oral tradition and the word of mouth for the continuation of their sacred stories, prayers, and yearly cycle. The mouth in this instance is symbolic for the source of wisdom. This rune of the Æsir has also been connected specifically to Wotan and Mercury, implying associations with wisdom, magic and travel.



Although this rune would seem to imply speaking to others, in divination this rune implies being receptive to the word of mouth, in order to understand your place in the cosmos. It can indicate that one needs to pay attention to what is being spoken by others in order to relate to their place in the community, or it can serve to remind one of the need to relate to the divine and their spiritual journey. As Wotan was associated with mobility and travel, not merely in an earthly sense, but trans-navigating the various worlds, this rune can be related to the role of the shaman, and the necessity of connecting to the direct experience of non-ordinary reality.

This rune appears in both a positive and negative form, as the rune is not have a horizontal axis of symmetry and therefore changes its form when inverted. In the positive sense, it can be indicative of a positive transmission of oral wisdom resulting in spiritual and communal growth. Inverted it can indicate a challenge to one's capacity to understand, or a presence of misleading information. As always, the presence of other runes provides the context to understand the symbolism of Ansur in both of its forms in order to clarify its meaning. For instance, an inverted Ansur in combination with an upright Ur could indicate the presence of a immanent test or challenge to one's understanding, coupled with the courage to meet the challenge and transform. In its purest inverted form, Ansur can initiate an awareness of the need to relinquish your illusions, and confront reality from a changed perspective. And as the name of the rune implies, you will always have helpers and guides from the other worlds to assist you.

This is the fourth in a series of articles aimed at providing some basic information regarding the Germanic runes, their symbolism and use in divination. These writings are intended to explain each rune in detail, with the proper mythological and cultural context to provide an accurate foundation upon which one can begin their journey with this esoteric writing system.

Still Living the Good Life ~ Matthew Sicher

The presence of my son Elijah has brought many new values the forefront of my life. Jesse and I have long valued developing and deepening relationships with our elders. With Elijah now in our lives, I've been especially motivated to be sure he gets to meet some of the many influential elders in my life.

With that motivation in mind, Jesse and Elijah and I recently went out on a visiting day (*B'such Daag* in PA Deitsch). It had been several years since I had been to Uncle Richard and Aunt Marjorie's house to visit, and it was inspiring as always. Richard is Elijah's Great Great Great Uncle!

Richard and Marjorie live in the simple and stunningly beautiful house that Richard built, with ongoing help from my second cousin Steve. It is a log and stone house, from stone found on the land, and logs felled from the land. The central Summer Beam is hand hewn with a fine broad axe that used to belong to one of Uncle Richard's friends and influences, Mr. Daniel O'Hagen.

Uncle Richard built the house, and lived in it without electricity and running water for the first ten or so years. He dug his wells by hand, but initially could not find any water. When a neighbor suggested that he ask a local dowser to try, Uncle Richard initially dismissed the idea. However, after three wells were hand dug, with no water, he decided to give the dowser a call. The dowser indicated the area to dig, and lo and behold, water! Richard said he was completely convinced at that point of the value of dowsing, and has learned and practiced it ever since.

I have always been moved by a visit to Richard's house, not only for the physical beauty of the place, but also for the stories heard and lessons learned. One of the factors making Uncle Richard's story so intriguing is that he earned a doctorate, (from Harvard no less) and then decided on a life of simple living. He's satisfied his need for fine physical surroundings by creating a masterfully built home and fine cabinetry, and his need for intellectual expression by writing several works on Henry David Thoureau.

Richard and his beautiful handy work have influenced me, and my understanding of a good life for a number of years. At age fifteen, having expressed an interest in learning and continuing simple and traditional crafts, my mother was interested and thoughtful enough to take me to talk with Uncle Richard. She wanted to support me in my life decisions, but said that at that time she did not have much advice to share to influence my life decisions.

At one point in this visit my mother asked, "but Uncle Richard, isn't this a hard life that you've chosen?"

In response to which Richard paused and said, "Well, it is if you don't want to be living it… It would be a much harder life for me if I had to work in an office all day."

This made a profound impression on me. Especially at that age I was hearing well-intended advice from all sides as to the way to live a good life. However, much of this advice was focused solely on landing the most lucrative job. Uncle Richard taught me then, and teaches me still that living the good life cannot be defined by simply consulting the size of my paycheck.

This is, I believe, a valid tenet of healthy communities past and present. The need for material abundance and security is important for every generation. There must be however a distinction made between quantity and quality. Today, in much of the United States we are truly blessed with great abundance, to be readily earned by hard work. Now with such abundance, the beauty and validity of masterful craftsmanship is more apparent that ever.

In this most recent visit we spent some time in his carpentry shop. This small workshop, with froe and maul split oak shakes on the roof, is where he makes his beautiful and rustic furniture. He calls it "historical replication" furniture, but explained that this name isn't really accurate. The corner china cabinet in his house is one of his, and utilizes a door from another old cabinet,

detailed joinery, and a wooden handle, lock, and hinge.

On admiring this work Uncle clarified that he is not attempting to regress to an older era of building, or glorify archaic practices. The ongoing value of hand made goods not only introduces a beauty sorely needed in the Western home, but also serves to remind us that we are all capable of producing functional beauty with little more than our two hands. Since bringing electric to his house, in over forty years of securing his livelihood through woodworking, he has a drill and circular saw, with all his other tools being hand tools.

Finding contentment and a sense of meaning in my everyday life is, I have found, a central part to living the good life. Through Uncle's home and life philosophy, I am able to see one example of what a life may look like with these principles taken seriously. Orienting my life toward appreciating the simple and little glories with which we are presented every day seems to me a sort of emotional savings account. If I am always striving to find contentment with the everyday, then when adverse winds do blow my way, I am in enough of a state of tranquility to cope. Whereas if I insist on seeing the happenings of everyday as either inadequate, or overwhelming, then any stumbling points encountered are all the more unendurable.

The sense of, not only peace, but inspired contentment that I feel whenever I am visiting Uncle are states of being I pray that my home will invoke. With that prayer in my heart, and being expressed through my hands, I am now beginning the process of building our home. We have finished designing a beautiful and functional home, and I have now begun the first stages of building. I will be writing several upcoming articles on some aspect of this diverse, challenging, and exciting project.

As with many things in this life, I find that along with researching material and technical considerations, consulting my elders invaluably informs my perspectives. Such is the case with the house I am building. As Uncle said about his cabinetry, I am attempting not to replicate days gone by, but to take modern knowledge and technology in combination with the grace and quality craftsmanship that have historically been the hallmark of our culture. I am excited to find this elusive balance in my house as well as the rest of my life, and I will share the process in these pages.





Four Humors Medicine ~ Part 2 by Annie Hasz



Galen, Avicenna and Hippocrates, Canon of Medicine

Dreaming a Cure

Faith in the individual's ability to find truth through connection with spirit is the power that breathes life into the Braucherei tradition. It will certainly enrich the practice of the inheritors of Braucherei to meditate on the constellation of creative medical ideas in our ancestor's world. Fascinating faith traditions were seamlessly integrated with healing practices in most ancient cultures, becoming distinct only in the Greek world.

Faith Healing: An Ever-present Counterpart to Rational Medicine

Intuition and spirit are inseparably involved in our physical health. Rational medicine slights the work of true healing when it snubs medicine which is imbued with spirit and faith. In Greece, the birthplace of western philosophy and much of rational, scientific medicine, a separation between rational and spiritual traditions developed. Celsus reports that Hippocrates was the first to distinguish medicine from philosophy, to pull it from its spiritual ties and give it mechanistic attribution. The Platonic understanding that reason is paramount and can trump even strong intuition separated the faith healers from the rational doctors. In Plato's Phaedrus, Socrates compares medicine, the art of persuading the body to health, with rhetoric, the art persuading the soul to truth. Socrates then asks, "can the nature of the soul be determined without knowledge of the whole?". I would counter Socrates and ask, can the nature of the body be determined without knowledge of the whole?

A sense of alignment with the divine has been part of our well-being for eons. Saunders notes that "all primitive cultures have sought divine inspiration through the dreams provoked by fasting, prayer, and isolation, or by some other means such as drugs" but this seeking is not limited to primitive cultures. In Egyptian times, a cult developed around the figure of Imhotep, a historical man who was posthumously assigned qualities of Thoth, "the Ibis-headed moon god and the outstanding medical divinity, scribe of the gods and the discoverer of healing herbs". Priests entered into temples to sleep and while in a trance or resting state, they would diagnose and treat patients. The practice of temple sleep or incubation was incorporated into Greek life as well. In interesting parallel to Imhotep, a physician named Asklepios (or Asculapiues, etc.) also inspired a cult of faith healers after his passing. He became deified as Apollo's son, eventually gaining a place as a major god in the Roman pantheon, and an Asklepian temple was erected on Cos one century after the founding of the Hippocratic school of medicine . In this medical temple, and others like it throughout Greece, science and magic fused.

Continued on page 12...



YARROW

Achillea millefolium

Thousand Leaf, Nosebleed

Yarrow is a perennial wildflower with low growing leaves and tall flower spikes that grow as tall as three feet. The 3 inch umbel flowers are composed of tiny white flower clusters and the leaves are finely cut and feathery in appearance. It blooms from June through August. Gather leaves anytime and the flowers when they are pearly white

Traditional medicinal uses: Yarrow is a wonderful fever herb. Drink 2-3 cups of hot tea, best taken in small sips throughout the day, when flu symptoms occur. Climb into bed, bundle up and sweat your fever out. Cover your feet with chopped garlic and wear wool socks. Yarrow stimulates the immune system to suppress viruses and bacteria. Works best in combination with elderflower and peppermint (add in some catnip for children)

2) Yarrow is an excellent wound herb, by cleaning a wound of bacteria and as a styptic, which means it can stop bleeding: from a deep cut, nosebleeds, coughing blood or postpartum bleeding. Also stops profuse menstrual bleeding.

3) As an anti-inflammatory and antispasmodic, yarrow is used for diverticulitis, irritable bowel syndrome, mucus colitis and Chrohn's disease. It also stops diarrhea and bleeding. Works best in combination with catnip and wild yam.

Topical Use: Crushed leaf or flower applied to a bleeding wound or nosebleed

Contraindications: None known

Interesting Historical Facts and Folklore

The genus name , *Achillea,* honors the Greek hero, Achilles, who applied yarrow leaves to heal many of his warriors wounds during the battle of Troy. During the Civil War, medics used yarrow as a surgical dressing to staunch the flow of blood. The PA Dutch use this as a "sweating tonic' to reduce fever by preparing one oz. of dried yarrow to one pint of boiling water. After straining, the infusion was sweetened with honey and a dash of cayenne pepper was added. Yarrow was always part of the 'sacred 9' herb bundles that originally were a pre-Christian tradition, but eventually the women's herb bundles were sanctified and even blessed in the church on Mary's Ascension Day the 15th of August

References :

Plant Names and Plant Lore among the PA Germans-Brendle (1927)

Sauer's Herbal Cures -- William Woys Weaver (2001)

A Modern Herbal– Mrs. M. Grieve (1931)

Culpeper's Complete Herbal-Nicholas Culpeper (1653)

Herbal Therapeutics –David Winston, AHG (2003)

Four Humors Medicine cont'd from page 10…

Modern healers, reading the records of the cures supposedly achieved in Greek temple medicine believe that Asclepius' followers were practicing psychotheraphy. It is possible that temple medicine initiates, through suggestion and hypnosis or with soporifics, created mental states that would even allow physicians to perform surgery .Very probably, the healers were often practicing something akin to shamanic journeying.

Even Galen allowed some healing merit to incubation, especially in diagnostics. He believed that in deep rest, with the conscious mind extinguished, the soul could shine into the depths of the body to perceive its state of health. In granting the situational efficacy of temple sleep Galen reflected the views of Hippocrates and many other rational physicians. These healers recognized the limits of rationality in developing treatment for human beings who are not merely the sum of their blood, bone, sinew, their fluids and solids.

Braucherei: Carrying the Heirloom of a Spiritual Four Humors

Though the medieval doctor looked to Galen's Hippocrates as the founder of the profession, beginning in the advent of the enlightenment era doctors witnessed the diminishment of Galen's Greek medicine. In 1628, the anatomist Harvey's discoveries about the function of circulation demonstrated that Galen's physiology was flawed. The medical historian Le Clerc wrote a history of medicine just before the close of the 17th century in which he credited Hippocrates with the foundation of the four humors/four quality theory in the Nature of Man, but wondered how this could be reconciled with the "infinity of humors" in another corpus text Ancient Man. The physician Herman Boerhaave felt that the medicine of Hippocrates was given more precision by the anatomically saavy physicians in Alexandria and he ascribed to the Hippocratic method of sound regimen. But Boerhaave felt that Galen's explanation of the medical material of eras past by "the qualities commonly called cardinal, by their gradations and by the four humors" was executed with "much more subtlety than truth".

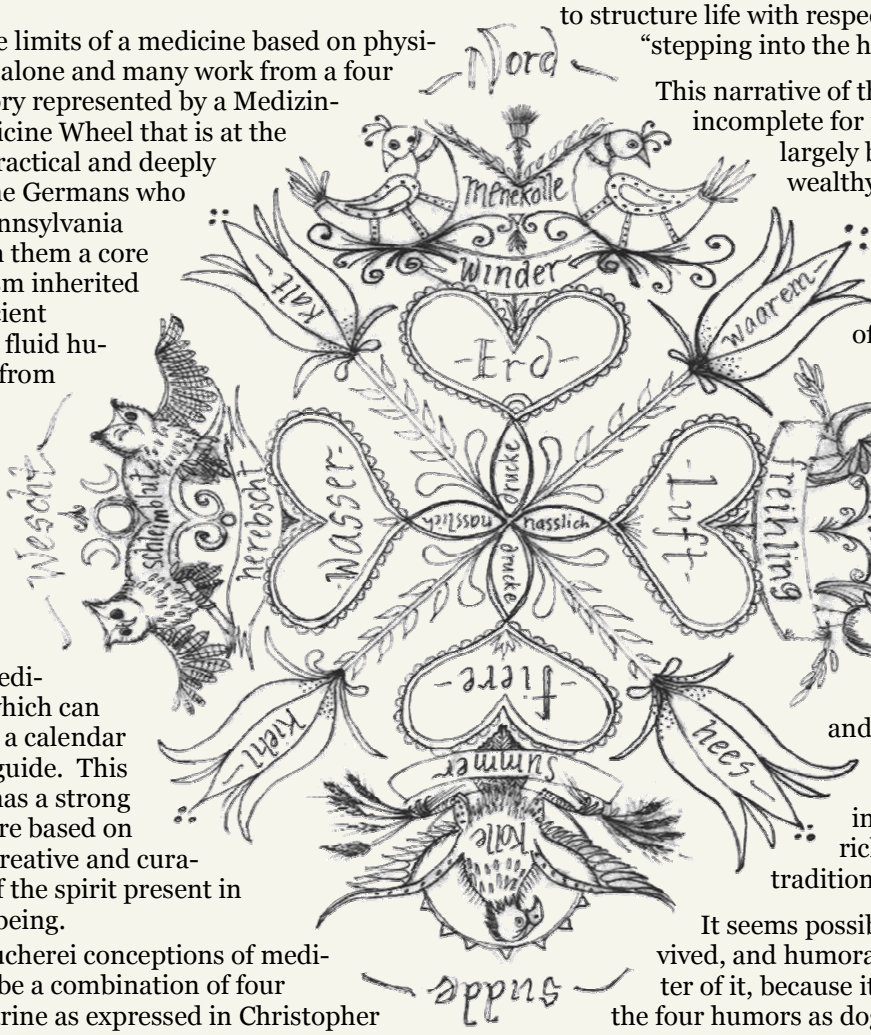
The fifteenth century physician Paracelsus, whose practice greatly impacted the Braucherei tradition, railed against the Galenic medical dogmatism that ruled in his time. He loathed Galen's four humors medicine, perhaps because it was prescriptive and could be applied quite mechanically. He had an ardent faith that God had revealed healing practice to him and was especially inspired by notions of spiritual alchemy. Paracelsus believed the human being was a microcosm of the world and was composed of three predominant chemicals: salt, sulfur, and mercury bound together by a fluid called archaeus. Illness was caused by a deficiency in one of these constituents and herbal medicine and dietetics are effective therapies because plants also contain salt, sulfur, and mercury, but in different ratios. For cure, one must ingest plants with a ratio of chemicals that will right your deficiency. This practice is quite reminiscent of some versions of humoralism with the name and nature of the constituents altered.

But the essential contribution of Paracelsus was his insistence on the primacy of spiritual insight in healing practice, the necessity to become medically learned through personal experience and not the medical texts of Galen and Avicenna, still in use in the 15th Century – about 1300 years after Galen systemized Greek medical information. The detractors of Paracelsus maintained that he had not "entered the temple of knowledge through the 'legitimate door' because too much of his practice was derived from folk healers and his own experience. To this criticism Paracelsus countered: "But which one is the truly legitimate door? Galenus and Avicenna or Nature? I have entered through the door of Nature: her light…has illuminated my way". Paracelsus' view of nature's role in healing was directly contradicted by dogmatically educated physicians like Benjamin Rush, for example, who "had no confidence in Mother Nature and insisted that she be driven from the sick room as one would a stray dog or cat". Paracelsus believed that Hippocrates had a true medical sprit but "Galen and other sophists had perverted his views".

The versions of humoral doctrine are energetic systems, ways to describe the "physiological and psychological patterns in the body" that spring from the vital force of the organism. Most practitioners abandoned all language resembling humoralism once the use of the microscope lead to the discovery of animicular particles – now known familiarly as germs -- and extensive anatomical exploration led to an etiology based on specific lesions. John Locke, the English philosopher, observed with some concern the increasing excitement over new medical discoveries made possible by technology, warning that "though we cut into the inside, we [still] see but the outside of things and make but new superficies to stare at". Diseases were no longer spoken of as expressions of broader patterns, as imbalances of four humors or qualities or the result of the effect of pneuma.

The energetic systems of our ancestors, though they may be deepened and refined by new scientific medical discoveries, must be conserved as valuable heirlooms and precious tools for healing. Modern western health care has fallen into the very trap John Locke warned about, increasing blindness to deeper patterns even as it opens our eyes to molecular detail. Though this health care is armed to the teeth with technology, it is losing its battle.

Western Society is haunted by cultural diseases that originate in diseased spirit and a daily life that doesn't encourage physical well-being. These ills are caused by blindness to broad patterns, to the importance of regimen and spiritual health, and to the curative power of the individual. The therapy of modern biomedicine does not engage the energy of the body in healing. The practitioners of the Southeastern Pennsylvanian folk healing tradition known as Braucherei recognize the limits of a medicine based on physical anatomy alone and many work from a four humors theory represented by a Medizinraad or Medicine Wheel that is at the same time practical and deeply spiritual. The Germans who settled in Pennsylvania brought with them a core of humoralism inherited from the ancient Greeks. The fluid humors derive from paired elemental qualities and are matched with the cardinal directions and the seasons, creating a medicine wheel which can also serve as a calendar and a spirit guide. This health care has a strong shamanic core based on faith in the creative and curative power of the spirit present in every living being.



Braucherei conceptions of medicine tend to be a combination of four humors doctrine as expressed in Christopher Sauer's Herbal, the heroic medicine of Samuel Thomson, and the practices of Native Americans and other settlers in the Appalachians . In Sauer's herbal, each remedy is classified according to its elementary quality – hot, dry, cold, or moist -- and its essential salt, a way of describing an herb's active properties that comes from the 15th century physician Paracelsus. Several Braucherei practitioners of the 20th and 21st century carry versions of four humors theory at the heart of their healing work.

The diversity of Braucherei folk medical practice is revealed in interviews conducted by Dennis Boyer and the founders of the Three Sisters Center for the Healing Arts with Brauchers in the 20th century. Most describe a very spiritual use of the medicine wheel and the four humors, associating certain energies with each quadrant or quality of the wheel. One man from Clearfield County understands his healing work as restoring a deficiency in one of the elemental or directional energies, and this he does with stones or herbs imbued with the needed energy. He describes healing according to the medicine wheel and learning to structure life with respect to seasonal energies as "stepping into the hoop" .

This narrative of the four humors theory is incomplete for its historical information is largely based on the records of wealthy physicians, unrepresentative of the field of physicians and healers and possibly holding ideas atypical of the majority of the "folk" of that era. It is ironic to look for the genesis of traditions still carried by a folk tradition in the records of the rich and famous. Yet despite these shortcomings the diversity of ideas on disease and healings propounded by prominent ancient philosophers and physicians inspires us to imagine the richness of the ancient folk traditions that still rests occluded.

It seems possible that Braucherei has survived, and humoralism has thrived at the center of it, because it never adopted a version of the four humors as dogma. It never fell into the trap of highly systematized medicine that inflexibly followed Galen's four humors as medical law. Instead, the Braucherei tradition has dynamically responded to the insights of experience and evolved throughout the years and throughout the lifetimes of individual practitioners. In the spirit of Paracelsus, Brauchers understand in healing they merely serve as a conduit for the creative work of the holy spirit in the individual.

Our Authentic Heirlooms *by Matthew Sicher*

The cold and wet and winds of winter have finally arrived here in Pennsylvania. Our fine and verdant garden has once again yielded an abundance of useful and beautiful fruits and vegetables. Our bounty is safely harvested and tucked away in our freezers, jars, and bellies, and our beds are clean and ready for next year's blessings and mysteries.

Each year tiny seeds miraculously bring forth food and beauty. I am always struck not only by the biological improbability of our food plants, but also the improbably long and intimate relationships we humans have developed with the sustaining plant world. Whether nomadic, semi-nomadic, or agriculturalist all peoples are, by necessity bound with their food and medicine plants.

The Pennsylvania German people have traditionally been agriculturalists, and masterful agriculturalists at that. Before the advent of reliable food storage and transportation, PA German farming communities were by necessity focused on self-reliance. Even after consistent and quick transportation became viable, self-sufficiency continues to be held in high esteem throughout much of the culture.

These thoughts occupy my mind now, because in our days of easy trading, the 2009 seed catalogs are arriving in our homes. Throughout the catalogs I frequent, I see many seeds advertised as "heirloom". This romantic term means that the seeds being sold are open-pollinated, and therefore care is taken to ensure that they are genetically pure. This feat is achieved by the tireless effort put forth by us humans as we attempt to mold the whims of nature to fit our needs and desires.

Genetically pure seeds must be grown and harvested in specific ways, year after year, generation after generation. In our modern focus on only a few select characteristics in our plant and animal allies, we have lost literally thousands of varieties of plants and animals that had been cultivated and bred over multiple generations. It is not only a great shame that so much of this diversity has been lost, but also a danger. The more diversity we have in our food source, the more adaptable we are in the face of change.

Considering the radical changes that the PA German and other traditional cultures have endured, it is nearly miraculous when these age-old "heirloom" seeds do survive. I share this now because I believe in the value of growing and preserving heirloom seeds, and I would like to share the story of one of the varieties I consume and care for year after year.

One of the most important things about an heirloom is its story…

I grow a short season French-fingerling style potato with salmon-red skin, pale meat, and a long, reliable shelf life. When planting time comes in the spring, the seed potatoes are nearly jumping out of their baskets, their lavendar-pink runners overflowing the tops and weaving through the basket slats in tangles of vivid color. When I was entrusted with this potato, I was told that it is called the "July Potato", because, "you can plant it as late as July and still harvest before the winter". I received the July Potato from Earl Odenheimer.

Earl is an elder and a mentor. I first received some potatoes, along with other plants from him when he was a spry 85 years old. At that time he was still growing most of his own produce, eating well throughout the growing season, and preserving it for winter. Earl has been growing organic produce since 1935! He proudly declares that he, "never got fooled by the false promises of chemical agriculture". Mister Odenheimer teaches the importance of healthy soil in producing healthy food, and says that healthy food is one of the best ways available to us living a good life.

When he passed on the July potato he said, with a glint of pride and purpose in his eyes, "I got these potatoes from an old-timer when I was a young man, and he got them from his father when he was a young man. I've been growing them ever since, and now its up to you. All these years I've been growing them, I've never seen them anywhere else, so you better take care of them." I have taken this charge and honor seriously, and each year many, many pounds of July potatoes are planted.

The July potato grows vigorously, seems drought tolerant, produces good yields, and stores well. All around I can easily see why this potato has been cultivated and saved for many generations; though just how many, we can't know. Earl said he thought that his old neighbor's father's father brought them over from Germany. But just as with so many things in our dear folk traditions, its origins become foggy and hard to decipher with time and distance.

I am enthusiastic about seed saving of all kinds, and especially when a plant or seed is passed from person to person, and contains its own story. I encourage everyone interested in producing food to look into heirloom seeds. Pick a variety, and learn how to care for it. Especially if a seed has a human story or lineage, for goodness sake, remember it and pass along both the seeds and the stories. In these ways our plants truly become our heirlooms. Every time I talk about, eat, plant, and share the July potato with others, I not only talk about its characteristics, but I always talk about my friend Earl.

'Our Authentic Heirlooms' cont'd...

How wonderful for a man who has lived many decades of his life focused on real food to be spoken of and appreciated whenever his July potato is doing its job, which is to provide sustenance and deepen community. As I write this, Earl is a contented and inspiring 93 years old. He has given his blessing to share and write about the July potato. As his name is now bound with our heirloom potato, I can only hope that as my decades unfold, I can pass on the July Potato with as much appreciation and grace as Mister Earl Odenheimer.

This telling of our heirloom's story ends in the twenty-first century. After I had expanded my stores of the potato adequately, I sent some up to Kadagar Farm, a seed-savers farm in Industry, Maine. The man who runs Kadagar did some genetic testing after his store of the potatoes was established. He was then excited to find that our July Potato is a variety that he had also been growing, but had lost several decades ago! And so, as with so many areas of our work at Three Sisters, we have come full circle and fulfilled our most important aim: to act as a bridge from the old ways to the new.

Thanks to Earl's decades of care and devotion to traditional agriculture, this bit of heritage has been kept alive for generations to come. Thanks to Kadagar Farm, it is now available again to all who seek it. As of this writing, the July potato has found its way into the fields of at least 3 local organic farms with CSA's: Quiet Creek, Red Earth Farm, and Season's Harvest... and every season we share it more!



When the dogs or the cats eat grass, there will be rain.

The PA German dialect translation on page 5

Chickweed continued from page 4

Pour into containers and allow to set overnight in a cool, dark room. If they do not set well overnight, put the salve back into the pot, re-heat, and add more beeswax.

Once the product has set, if necessary, use your fingertip to melt a bit of it onto your finger and apply to the itchy area.

This works wonders for me, and I hope you enjoy making it as much as I do!

Kannscht du Deitsch schwetze?

Are you interested in learning Pennsylvania German, but you are not sure where to study it?

Affordable, c ommunity-based classes for Fall 2009 are now forming. Beginners are most welcomed! No experience is necessary in any foreign language.

Contact Rob Lusch:

by telephone at 215-499-1323

or

by e-mail at schreiwer@urglaawe.org.

Oschdre continued from page 6

With an altar full of flowers and candles and a second altar bearing dyed eggs (some dyed naturally, others, admittedly, used modern techniques), holy mead and apple cider, and other offerings, we hailed the arrival of Oschdre and thanked the goddesses and gods for the blessings of this bountiful land.

From here we begin the spiritual time of indoor planting and preparation for Walpurgisnacht, which falls on April 30 and signifies the return of Haerrin Holle to the soil. Pennsylvania German tradition holds that three Frost Giants (or Frost Spirits) pass through in May (13th, 14th, 15th), after which it is safe to plant anything outdoors.

Hail Oschdre!



Living Land

By Rob Lusch

Today is April 5 (5. Oschdret on the Urglaawe calendar), and it is finally a warm spring day. The land is alive with wild plants, including a large crop of Hinkeldarm (chickweed) that is ready to be reaped.

Pennsylvania German tradition, through Braucherei, holds that there is a sacred promise between plants and man and between animals and man. Domesticated plants and animals sacrifice themselves for good of this promise. Mankind, in turn, serves the plants and animals by ensuring that another generation of each will thrive.

The Butzemann, who first appeared in the Grundsaudaag post back in February, represents the plants' portion of this sacred promise. He is made out of remnants and stalks of last year's crop; thence, he is the "father" of this year's crop. He has been shown the perimeter of this his land, and he will now stand guard over that territory. He will remain in the garden getting battered by wind, weather, and the hot sun, and ultimately he will be burned on Allelieweziel (31 October Gehling).

Frost-sensitive plants will not be planted outdoors until May 15 (15 Wonnet) as Pennsylvania German lore indicates that three Frost Giants (or Frost Spirits) pass through the land on May 13, 14, and 15.

However. many plants are already greening on their own, so the Butzemenner are already out in fields and gardens.

The time between Oschdre and Walpurgisnacht (30 Oschdret/Abrill) is to be used for preparation and action. We are to begin to activate our New Year's Resolutions and to take the significance of our promises into our hearts. We are to reflect on the cycle of life, death, and rebirth and how this cycle applies in our lives even today. Sometimes sacrifices are required of us in order to ensure that the next generation thrives. So let us plant the next generation and help it to grow and to succeed. :)



Die Versommling!!

Da meh mir kumme samme,
Kumme samme, kumme samme,
Da meh mir kumme samme,
Da hallicher mir sinn!

The more we come together
Together, together,
The more we come togethe ,
The jollier we'll be!



Upper Right: Elijah and Rob dance to the music

Above: Dan Riegel at the Versommling

Lower Right: Rob and some of his Students chow down on traditional Deitsch cuisine.

that soon their English lyrics can be replaced with Deitsch ones.

When the death of a language has seemed so immanent for so long, it is exciting to see the effect that a few passionate people can have. The young faces that attended the Versommling this year are a testament to the fact that Deitsch youth aren't giving up yet!



This year we celebrated the 70th annual Berks County Versommling. The first Berks county Versommling was held in 1937 in Reading. At that gathering there was a fine for speaking English, a far cry from today's event. Now many of the attendees to the Versommling speak little or no Deitsch, though the majority are still native speakers. This year there were approximately 850 attendees to the Versommling. Unfortunately for Deitsch speakers, few of these attendees were younger than 60.

In light of the reality of the aging population of native Deitsch speakers, Rob Lusch is trying to turn the tide. Rob has been teaching Deitsch at Kutztown University this year. He has focused heavily on new and innovative ways of helping young people to connect with the language. He hopes to see more Deitsch media in the future: music, movies, newspapers, etc. Dan Riegel is a student of Rob's at Kutztown, and hopes to help Rob in his quest for Deitsch media. Dan is a member of a band (he plays the fiddle), and hopes



'Der Braucherei Weg'

The Braucher's Path

12 Month Course

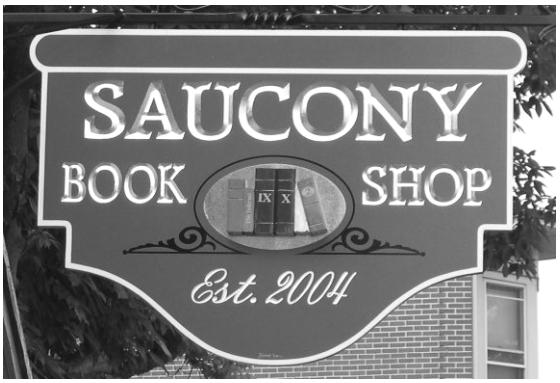
Next session begins January 2010

Now Available on CD for Distance Learning !

For more information

Contact Jesse at

484-336-4611



The Saucony Book Shop, located in the heart of scenic rural Berks County, epicenter of Pennsylvania German folk culture, offers a full range of gently used, rare, and antiquarian books, with many volumes of scholarly merit and an unabashed emphasis on the quaint, the curious, and the utterly obscure.

Store hours: T W F 12-6 p.m.,

Sat. 10 a.m.-5 p.m.

41 West Main St.
Kutztown, Pennsylvania 19530



Kutztown Area Historical Society

Normal Avenue and White Oak Street
Kutztown, PA 19530 610.683.7697

Farm at Coventry's



"Homestead Herbalism"

9-Month Course

Next session begins March 2010

www.FarmatCoventry.com

Questions? Contact Susan at

610-469-9591

'Hollerbeier Haven' Guild Gatherings in Kutztown, PA

April 25, 2009 – En Deitsches Medizinraad The medicine wheel of the Deitsch people is a unique combination of many cultural influences: Greek, Jewish, Germanic, and Native American as well as many others. This has created a unique perspective in healing, as well as folklore surrounding the medicine wheel that is particular to Deitsch culture. Annie Hasz spent much of her time in the Braucherei Weg course studying the evolution of this medicine wheel, and its Greek Four Humors medical base in particular. She will share information about the evolution and use of this wheel in modern Braucherei practice.

May 30th, 2009—Of Plants and Sympathies This month Susan Hess and Rob Lusch will join together to bring us a coherent look at traditional Deitsch medicine. Susan has spent many years studying the folkloric use of Herbs in traditional medicine. In recent years she has pinpointed Deitsch use of Herbs in particular. Rob has spent his time in the study of prayers and sympathies as well as some of the "superstitions" of the Deitsch folk. In this guild meeting they will share both of these important elements of Deitsch folk medicine with us, demonstrating the integrated way in which many traditional cures were made.

June 27, 2009-"Blanzeschwetze"-Speaking with Plants" held at 'Farm at Coventry' in Pottstown, PA Jesse Tobin and Susan Hess will join together to discuss the Braucherei practice Blanzeschwetze" (speaking with plants). They will also discuss the ritual use of herbs. There are several medicinal herbs that are particularly important to the PA German healing tradition. Susan and Jesse will explain in depth about some of these plants: their character, cultural significance, and use in medicine and healing ceremony.

NEW LOCATION! Gatherings will be held at the Indigo Natural Healing Center on Rt 222

(15525 Kutztown Rd, Kutztown, PA 19530) on the last Saturday of the month from 10-3pm (unless otherwise noted) $35 members/$45 non-members. To register call Jesse at 484-336-4611 or email her at Thr3Sisters@aol.com

'Herbal Hands Workshops" in Pottstown, PA

Saturday May 2 10 am -3: Simple Soap Making Due to relentless demand, my resident 'soap meister' Mike, will be sharing his personal, time-tested techniques for whipping up small batches of soap. The class will cover: natural soap ingredients, tools and techniques, demystifying the LYE and pouring and curing. Mike will demonstrate the step by step process and you'll leave with informative handouts and one bar of Farm at Coventry soap! Soap making kits containing all the ingredients you need for a single batch of soap will be available for purchase on the day of the class.$40

Saturday June 6~ 10am -3: The Subtle Power of Rose-Therapeutic Uses of the Mythic Flower of Love
The damask roses will be in high bloom for this class! Learn about the myth and mystery surrounding the beloved rose. We will immerse ourselves with the fragrance, tastes and therapeutic uses of roses and create wonderful take home gifts utilizing fresh rose petals. Come prepared to experience the rose on a deep level. Handouts will include resource materials for growing roses organically, where to purchase your own fragrant heritage rose bushes and abundant recipes. Tina Sams, of the Essential Herbal is graciously sharing her glass still with us for the day, to make rose hydrosol!! Wear something pink or red if you can!! $40

Wednesday June 24 ~6:30-8:30 pm : Lavender Fields, Forever ! Tina Sams of the Essential Herbal Magazine will be giving us a distilling demonstration using lavender flowers this time, producing a bit of lavender hydrosol and maybe even a few drops of essential oil! We'll also immerse ourselves in lavender treats and beverages while Susan instructs us how to make pretty lavender wands using fresh flowering stalks! You'll each go home with recipes, instructional handouts and a finished wand. $30

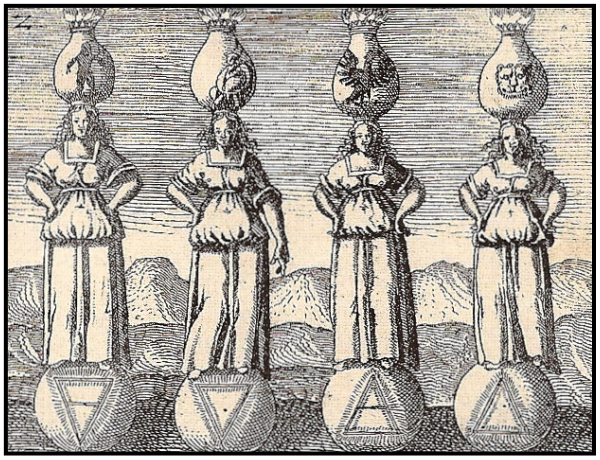
* **All Herbal Hands Workshops will be held at the Farm at Coventry on the first Saturday of the month from 10-3pm and cost $40 (unless otherwise noted) . To register call Susan at 610-469-9591 or visit www.FarmatCoventry.com to register online**

Three Sisters Center
for the Healing Arts
P.O. Box 88
Kempton, PA
19529

Visit our newly updated website ! www.ThreeSistersCenter.com

Hollerbeier Haven Guild Gatherings are now available on CD!!

For more information on past or future



events, contact Jesse at Three Sisters Center:
484-336-4611
Thr3sisters@aol.com
PO Box 88
Kempton, PA 19529